

EXAMINED

Gekko GX1

The Gekko GX1 is a hybrid wearable offering that comes with a range of sensors packed into a typical digital watch design. Take it out of the box, and it is bound to remind you of the G-Shock range from Casio and other similar watches. It sports a durable look, with a bold and sizeable case and wide straps. Don't take our word for it, the watch comes with an IP68 rating, so it can survive quite a few dips and tumbles.

There are four functional buttons on the Gekko X1 and one cosmetic structure that looks like a button but isn't one. While the most versatile button on the lower left lets you toggle between the different modes that the watch offers, a dedicated button above it lets you operate the light for the display. On the other side, the Start and Reset buttons mainly act as controls for some of the modes like the Stopwatch, Alarm clock etc. All of these buttons do require above-average effort to reach.

For the smarts of this hybrid watch, you'd have to connect it to its companion app on an Android phone. But even without the smarts, you get a number of sensors and their data on the watch, namely your step count, distance walked, calories burnt, the atmospheric pressure, altitude, temperature and UV intensity at your location along with the standard stopwatch and alarm clock features. The watch supports notification alert, message alert, call alert, and even has a



DND mode to turn all of this off – which we found ourselves doing quite a lot due to the 'beeping' sound that the watch makes whenever any notification lands up.

Save for some sensor errors, the Gekko GX1 doesn't disappoint. If you really want to go for a hybrid smartwatch with a particular affinity for G-Shock like designs, the closest design you can get from G-Shock is at a premium of ₹2k over this, and for the full set of features, you'd need to shell out as much as ₹16k for the G-Shock G485. Choose the Gekko GX1 and you might have a good, if not perfect, deal.

PRICE: ₹4995

Aisen Trolley Speaker - A12UKB800

There has been a sudden surge in trolley speakers lately as evident from this section where we have covered multiple of them. This time Aisen sent over their A12UKB800 trolley speaker and even you'd agree that it could have used a simpler name. Standing at about 3 feet tall, it has two large speakers along with two tweeters, delivering an output of 120W RMS. This setup should be able to deliver good sound quality. If you say it's heavy, then you should know that it has wheels on the bottom and it can be pulled using a handle. However, the wheels don't rotate. So whenever you need to move without lifting the speaker, you will have to tilt the speaker and use the trolley. Convenient, eh?

Playback support is amazing. You can connect any Bluetooth device with the speaker and use the hardware buttons to control the



volume and playback. It also supports playback through USB and SD cards. So, you can simply transfer songs to pen drives and play songs from it. For those who care, it can also connect to FM radio. There's built-in support for RCA connectivity as well and the box ships with a 3.5-inch to RCA cable.

Coming to the sound quality, you will be able to enjoy all your EDM and Dance music on this speaker. Hence, this would be best for house parties rather than depending on small Bluetooth speakers. An additional advantage of using these trolley speakers is that most of them ship with handheld wireless microphones. And who wouldn't like to attend a fun karaoke party right in the comfort of someone's home? Not just karaoke, the speaker also has a guitar input port. So if anyone happens to be great with the strings, they have the right tool to show it off.

PRICE: ₹12,499